Catalin Ionescu

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Senior Software Engineer with 7+ years building production systems across startup, enterprise, and safety-critical domains. Frontend-heavy full-stack - comfortable owning features end-to-end with React/Next.js/TypeScript on the client and Node.js, NestJS, or Spring Boot on the server. Recent work includes scaling a multi-brand Next.js platform serving ~10 brands on shared architecture, migrating a legacy Polymer codebase to Stencil.js for Norwegian railway systems, and shipping a full e-commerce marketplace from zero to production in under 2 months. I gravitate toward pragmatic solutions, measurable impact, and reducing complexity rather than adding to it.

Skills & Expertise

Frontend:shadcn/ui · Tailwind CSS · Stencil.js · Angular · Vue.js · Next.js · React · JavaScript · TypeScript
Backend:Microservices · REST APIs · Spring Boot (Java) · NestJS · Node.js
Testing:React Testing Library · Cypress · Playwright · Jest
Databases:MongoDB
DevOps & Tools:Varnish · Grafana · Bitbucket · GitLab) · Jenkins · CI/CD (Bamboo · AWS · Kubernetes · Docker

Professional Experience

Software Developer

The Workshop, Málaga, Spain

Oct 2024 – Present
• Architected and scaled a multi-brand Next.js platform serving ~10 brands with shared theming, routing, and CMS-driven content - dramatically reduced new brand onboarding time via an internal cloning wizard that automates theme, config, and structure setup • Improved application performance in a microservices environment through Varnish caching strategies and optimized data delivery patterns between frontend and backend services • Built and maintained automated test suites with Jest and Playwright, increasing coverage and reducing regression risk across brand deployments • Contributed to cross-service integrations within a distributed microservices architecture, improving data flow between frontend and backend systems • Owned CI/CD pipelines using Bitbucket and Bamboo for reliable, continuous delivery across multiple brand environments • Hackathon - 2nd place: designed and prototyped a web push notification system; later approved for potential production integration • Active contributor to code reviews and architectural discussions, raising team-wide code quality standards

Software Developer

Thales, Bucharest, Romania

Mar 2020 – Jul 2024
• Delivered safety-critical features for the Norwegian railway industry, implementing vital commands and train route optimization logic used in production rail operations • Led the migration from Polymer 2 to Stencil.js across the frontend codebase, modernizing component architecture while maintaining strict safety compliance requirements • Maintained a Java/Spring Boot microservice handling core processing logic, designed to minimize frontend preprocessing and centralize business rules server-side • Drove code refactoring initiatives focused on performance

optimization and long-term maintainability in a legacy enterprise codebase • Collaborated with Norwegian stakeholders, translating domain requirements into technical implementations

Software Developer

MindCell Systems, Bucharest, Romania

May 2019 – Mar 2020
• Led frontend development of a Smart Parking management platform using Angular, delivering core UI components and business logic • Contributed to Oraroo, an HR platform built in React focused on time logging and report generation • Worked across two concurrent projects, balancing delivery deadlines and context-switching between distinct product domains

Software Developer

Doraly Marketplace, Bucharest, Romania

Nov 2018 – May 2019
• Shipped a full-stack e-commerce marketplace from zero to production in under 2 months as part of a 3-person team • Built the frontend with Vue.js/Vuex and the backend with NestJS/MongoDB, moving fluidly across the stack • Established core development practices (testing, code review, deployment) from scratch in a fast-paced startup environment

Web Manager & QA

IBM Romania, Bucharest, Romania

Mar 2017 – Nov 2018
• Managed IBM Turkey's web presence (ibm.com/tr), transitioning from QA into a Web Manager role • Built an automation tool aggregating data from 100,000+ web pages, eliminating manual GDPR compliance verification for marketing teams • Transformed a repetitive compliance workflow into an automated pipeline, freeing up significant team capacity

Education

No Degree, Electrical Engineering

University Polytechnic of Bucharest, Bucharest, Romania

Oct 2014 –
Completed 3 years of Electrical Engineering, building a strong foundation in analytical problem-solving and applied mathematics. Developed programming skills in JavaScript and Java through coursework and self-directed learning. Made a deliberate decision to pursue software development full-time, entering the industry in 2017.

Bachelor's degree, Electrical

Technological College Costin Nenitescu, Buzău, Romania

Sep 2010 – Jun 2014

Languages

English (fluent)·Romanian (native)